



2026–2027 Family Handbook

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Who Do I Contact - "The Chart"

TOPIC	1ST CONTACT	2ND CONTACT	3RD CONTACT
INFORMATION			
Attendance	585-442-8340 (leave vm)	Teacher	Co-Director
Pick Up by New Person (not mom/dad)	Written Note at Drop Off	Co-Director	Operations Manager
Early Pick Up	Written Note at Drop Off	Co-Director	
Classroom / Curriculum	Teacher	Co-Director	
Confirmed Contagious Illness	Teacher	Co-Director	Operations Manager
Behavior	Teacher	Co-Director	
Building & Grounds	Maintenance Team Lead	Operations Manager	Chairperson
CO-OP			
Board Agenda Item	Board Secretary	Chairperson	Officers
Volunteering	Vice Chairperson	Chairperson	
Buyout	Operations Manager		
Meeting Information	Board Secretary	Chairperson	
BUSINESS			
Billing & Refunds	Operations Manager	Financial Treasurer	Chairperson
Donations	Financial Treasurer	Operations Manager	Chairperson
Enrollment & Forms	Registrar	Operations Manager	
Reimbursement	Operations Manager	Financial Treasurer	Chairperson
Scholarship	Operations Manager	Chairperson	Officers
CONFLICTS			
Grievance with Teacher	Teacher	Co-Director	Officers
Grievance with Parent	Co-Director	Chairperson	Officers
Grievance with Staff	Staff	Chairperson	Officers
Custody / Unauthorized Person	Operations Manager	Co-Director	

Introduction

Our History

Founded in 1964, Winton Road Nursery School holds a permanent Charter issued by the New York State Education Board of Regents as an education corporation. WRNS is an equal opportunity employer. The School employs four teachers, four teaching assistants, and an operations manager. WRNS was founded on the concept of semi-cooperative nursery education. Parents are members of a non-profit, non-sectarian corporation that administers the school through an elected Board of Directors. Parents have the opportunity to guide their child's first school experience as they share in decision making and team service.

Our Philosophy

At Winton Road Nursery School, children learn through experimentation, manipulation, and observation. Creative and dramatic play, art projects, music, and circle time activities combine to nurture social skills and language development, encouraging confidence and independence in every child. Children spend time outside almost every day.

Our Goals

- Building self-esteem, confidence, and Independence
- Making their own decisions and choices
- Experimenting, asking questions, and solving problems
- Expressing creativity
- Laying foundations for good social relationships
- Developing emergent writing, literacy, and language skills

Program Descriptions

Winton Road offers two early childhood programs based on the child's age by December 1st. The **Young Nursery program** serves two-year-olds and runs from 9:00 AM to 11:30 AM on either Monday/Tuesday or Wednesday/Thursday. Designed specifically for younger children, each class caps enrollment at nine students and is staffed daily by a teacher, an assistant, and rotating parent volunteers. Potty training is not required, though parents must supply their own diapers and wipes. The dedicated classroom features a child-sized bathroom, changing table, indoor slide, sensory table, and reading nook, with toys rotated regularly to maintain engagement. A typical young nursery day starts with open-ended play, a brief circle and story time, an art or sensory activity, and outdoor play.

The **Big Nursery program** serves children ages three to five and runs on three schedules – 2 Day, 3 Day, and 5 Day from 9am – 12pm. Parents are not required to volunteer daily, but they can schedule classroom visits or join the room helper team to cover staff absences. The curriculum spans three specialized classrooms, with children spending one-third of the year in each room alongside their teacher, teacher assistant, and peers. These spaces include the Art Room for daily optional art projects and cooperative games; the Housekeeping Room for sensory tables, dress-up, and Legos; and the Big Muscle Room for gross motor activities, blocks, and toy vehicles. Every room includes a child-sized bathroom and sink. During a daily visiting time, children safely explore all three rooms under the supervision of a dedicated hall monitor.

A typical big nursery day starts with open-ended play where children may move about the room choosing how they will start their day. Each room does a short circle and story time. Next, is visiting time, where children safely explore all three rooms under the supervision of a dedicated hall monitor. Children may visit the art room at this time to complete the daily art project. After visiting time, children return to their rooms to get ready for snack. At the end of the day, children head outdoors. On many occasions, children will play outside more than once a day, especially in the fall and late spring.

Requirements & Program Times				
	Young Nursery	Big Nursery 2 Day	Big Nursery 3 Day	Big Nursery 5 Day
Typical Hours	9am – 11:30am	9am – 12pm	9am – 12pm	9am – 12pm
Slow Start	Sept. Short Days	Sept. Short Days	1st Week Short Days	1st Week Short Days
Class Days	Mon/Tue or Wed/Thu	Tue/Thu	Mon/Wed/Fri	Mon–Fri
Ages	Age 2 by Dec 1	Age 3 – 5 by Dec 1	Age 3– 5 by Dec 1	Age 4–5 by Dec 1
Potty Training	Not Required	<i>Recommended</i>	<i>Recommended</i>	Required
Diapers & Wipes	Not Provided			
Max Class Size	9	10 / 11	10 / 11	11
Volunteer Days	Required	Not Required	Not Required	Not Required
Team / Board Role	Optional	Required	Required	Required

Parent Responsibilities

Parent members shall participate as follows, in accordance with the Bylaws.

- ☐ Abide by the code of conduct, policies, and other applicable requirements as laid out in the **Family Handbook**.
- ☐ **Attend the Community Meetings** (such as the September General Meeting and the May Annual Meeting) called by the Board of Directors.
- ☐ **Attend the Orientation Meeting and scheduled parent conferences.**
- ☐ Attend the **fall work day** prior to the first day of school. If attendance is not possible, the Board and/or Staff shall assign an alternative task during the school year. All Parent Members are required to participate, including those in buyout families.
- ☐ **Assist with fundraising** by making a suitable donation not to exceed \$75. All Parent Members are required to participate, including those in buyout families.
- ☐ Have the **child examined by a Doctor** within the year prior to the first day of school, and ensure all required immunizations have been administered prior to attendance.
- ☐ **Provide all required medical forms and immunization records** to the school prior to the commencement of the school year. The child will not be able to attend school until all necessary and complete records are submitted, and the requirement is deemed satisfied.
- ☐ Provide **transportation** for the child to and from school.
- ☐ Provide **supervision for children and guests when on school or church property** outside of the normal operations of the school day.
- ☐ Big Nursery parents shall provide a **snack** for the entire Big Nursery school on a rotating basis. Young Nursery parents provide a **snack** for their Young Nursery class on a rotating basis.
- ☐ Big Nursery Parents will serve on a **volunteer** team, serve as an Officer or Parent Representative on the Board of Directors, or select the **buyout** option and pay the required fee. Young Nursery parents are required to **assist in the classroom**, or select the **buyout** option and pay the required fee. Parents must provide childcare for siblings while working in the classroom. Infants worn, or in carriers, may be permitted on a case-by-case basis, at the teacher's discretion. **Childcare** will be provided for Board Meetings, as volunteer staffing permits.
- ☐ If selected, the **buyout** option exempts a family from the required volunteer service for Big Nursery on a team or on the Board of Directors, and/or Young Nursery classroom assistance assignments upon payment of associated \$600 fee. Should a family fail to fulfill their obligation for volunteering, the family will become obligated for the applicable buyout fee. Families will receive notice in writing of their unmet responsibilities, and will work with the Chairperson(s) and/or Vice Chairperson to complete their duties. The Board reserves the right to confirm the levy of the buyout fee via a vote, and upon affirmation, apply the imposed charge to the family account for the current and/or any future enrollment years. Such a matter shall only be brought to vote in the event that the following conditions have been met: that the family has met with the Chairperson(s), and that the Parent continues to fail to fulfill their obligation to their team, to the Board of Directors, and/or in the classroom beyond January 1st.

General Information

Parking

When you arrive at school, please park on the north side of the building by the playground. Spaces marked "15 min parking" are for our use. You may also use your 4-way hazards and park in the lane next to the playground for quick drop offs and pick ups.

Absences

Please leave a message at **585-442-8340** if your child will be absent. Frequent absences without notice to the school may result in termination of care.

Holidays / No School Days

While we generally follow the public school calendars of RCSD and Brighton for school holidays, we have our own days off that may not align with the public school calendar. A print version will be provided to all families and a digital version is available on the school website.

Snow Days

Occasionally, the nursery school may be closed due to weather or a building issue or emergency. You will NOT be called about these closings. Please check the closings on Channel 13 WHAM. School closings will also be posted on Jovial and in the GroupSpot app. Snow days may or may not be made up, depending on the number of school closures throughout the school year. If Brighton closes due to inclement weather, we will generally close. We will do our best to make the call to close as soon as possible so that families may make other arrangements for childcare as needed.

Catastrophic Illness

In the event that there is not adequate staff coverage, school may be closed and families will be notified.

Dress

Children should be dressed informally in **very** washable **labeled** clothes for play. Children should bring clothes suitable for outdoor play every day (see chart below). All items should be clearly marked with the child's name. Children are encouraged to dress themselves; providing them with appropriate items helps ensure their success. Help familiarize your child with their items before school begins and as seasons change. Expect their hands and clothes to come home dirty and their shoes to be sandy or muddy.

Families will be asked to send in an extra set of labeled clothes (including socks and underwear, or diapers if potty training) to keep at school for emergencies. As children grow and the seasons change, teachers will send home the extra clothes to swap for new sizes and seasonally appropriate items.

Outdoor Gear		
Sunny	Wet / Rainy	Cold / Snowy
Close toed sneakers (no crocs)	Close toed sneakers (no crocs)	Close toed sneakers (no crocs)
Sunscreen (apply at home)	Rainboots for outdoor play	Snow boots for outdoor play
Light jacket or zip up (if desired)	Raincoat	Insulated, waterproof snow jacket & pants OR all-in-one snow suit
		Waterproof mittens w/ mitten clip or string
		Warm hat, no scarves, please!

Tote Bags & Folders

Each child at Winton Road will be provided with a **sturdy cotton tote bag and plastic folder**. This bag serves as a “traveling cubby” for the child. The folder will have art projects and school information or notes home. **Label (or decorate!) the bag clearly with your child’s name.** The label should be visible without needing to open the bag. These bags are stored in a laundry basket during the day and at dismissal so being able to read them easily is important. Please make sure to **check & empty your child’s tote every day they attend school.**

Holidays & Celebrations

At WRNS, we approach holidays and celebrations in a thoughtful, inclusive, and developmentally appropriate way. We explore seasonal changes, cultural traditions, and family celebrations through stories, songs, games, and art. Our focus is on themes of gratitude, kindness, friendship, family, and community rather than exploring the specific religious components of different holidays. All activities are optional and if you would prefer your child not participate please let us know.

We invite you to come to the classroom to share a story, song, craft, or game associated with a holiday or tradition celebrated in your family. At WRNS we aim to plan our lessons and activities through a mirrors and windows approach. We want children to feel their cultures and traditions reflected in classroom activities while also being able to view the experiences of others in an age appropriate and fun way. After all, our only true affiliation is with play.

Parent Visits

Parents are welcome to visit throughout the school year in Young Nursery and Big Nursery. Parents are also encouraged to share special interests or talents (dance, music, cooking, nature, etc.) with the children. Help from willing hands, on days when there are messy projects, is also welcomed. Please check with your child’s classroom teacher(s) if you are interested in scheduling a visit.

Parents in Young Nursery volunteer in the room on a rotating basis. In the Big Nursery, parents interested in being in the classroom occasionally may join the room helper team, offer to cover a teacher's absence, or schedule a visit at the teacher’s discretion. Parent visits do not count toward the in-class helper requirement for YN or the room helper team for BN.

Through the school year, you can get creative with how you participate. Consider birthday visits, reading a book, helping on nature walk and sledding days, on messy art project days, social events after school, photographer, yard clean up, organizing, diaper-food-clothing drives, supplies shopping, book fair helper, fundraising events, last minute room helping, and more. Ask your teacher how you can participate!

Parent-Teacher Communication And Conferences

Communication between teachers and parents is an essential aspect of the philosophy of WRNS. One of the most effective means of communication with parents is through conferences. In this way, parents and teachers can work together toward consistent guidelines for children at home and at school. In August, parents are invited to an evening orientation. During the first week of school, children and parents are invited to a meet & greet day, then a “mini” day where the children attend class and the caregivers attend a coffee hour.

In the fall, teachers will provide a check-in to parents. This check-in will cover general behaviors and how each child is adjusting to WRNS. This check-in is a time to connect and to address if there are areas where support is needed. Teachers will work with families to make a plan for the child's continued success at Winton Road.

In January, parent/teacher conferences are scheduled for each child's family and participation is mandatory. Child care will be provided during these conferences. If parents have questions or concerns at other times throughout the year, they should contact their teacher to arrange for additional discussion.

From time to time, your teacher may include a note home in your child's bag. Communicating at the end of the day can be tricky as children are ready to leave (or need to be helped to leave) and there are many parents waiting at the gate. Please email or call your child's teacher if you'd like to discuss something, or set a time to meet with them before or after school.

Email Communication Guidelines

Email communication should not be used as a replacement for phone calls or meeting in person, but rather to augment them, as a means to enhance the contact between teachers and families. Below are some guidelines for using email to contact your child's teacher.

- Please do not email absence notices, early dismissals, permission for another individual to pick-up your child, etc. to a teacher. There is no guarantee that these messages will reach your child's teacher in time. Please call the office (442-8340) or speak to your teacher in person about such matters, unless your teacher requests otherwise.
- Feel free to use email should you want to schedule a time to call your teacher after school hours to schedule a time to meet in person, or to relay simple information regarding your child. Serious matters should be discussed by telephone or in person.

Social Media

For outreach and advertising purposes, we use a Facebook Page and Instagram page and the publicity team welcomes your thoughts or contributions to improve it. We post photos of activities and the classrooms, and we intentionally avoid posting the faces of children on these social media pages. If you would like to contribute photos, please reach out to the Publicity team leader.

Groupspot App & Notifications

WRNS has a private group on Groupspot for posting school news, group chats, announcements, events, photos, signups, and more. It can be accessed via the web or downloaded as an app for iOS and Android. A sign up link will be provided at orientation and by emailing the Operations Manager. Families may customize their notification settings and set up email alerts. We strongly recommend that all families use the app regularly to stay informed.

Jovial Parent Portal

Our school uses Jovial, a parent portal designed specifically for cooperative schools. In Jovial, you may pay tuition, view the class roster, complete forms, and check for any school-related updates. For assistance with Jovial, please contact the Operations Manager.

Accessing Your Portal

- To access your account, go to <http://www.jovial.org/wintonroad/family> and enter your email.
- Click **Get Access Link**
- Check your inbox for a link from Jovial.org. This link will work for 30 days.
- Click the link in the email to log in.
- (*Optional*) In the top right corner of Jovial, click the person icon and set a password to skip the email step.

Tuition & Finances

Our school is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization. We are a semi-cooperative school, and attempt to keep tuition as low as possible by offering our time and help as needed. Tuition is to be paid in four payments due April 1, June 1, September 1, and November 1, unless other arrangements have been made in advance with the Operations Manager. We offer a 3% tuition discount for payment in full, as well as a 2% discount for each child when siblings are enrolled concurrently. The amounts listed below do not include this discount. For instructions on how to pay your bill online, see Page 8 under Jovial > Paying Your Bill.

Payments

To pay by check, make it payable to Winton Road Nursery School and mail it to Winton Road Nursery School, PO Box 10281, Rochester, NY 14610. Please do not bring checks to the school or church building.

To pay online, login to your Jovial portal at jovial.org/wintonroad/family and click Billing. Payments made by ACH have no fee, and payments made with credit or debit cards incur a 3.4% + \$.30 fee. To keep costs low, we ask families to donate this fee so that we can continue this convenient payment option.

Tuition for 2026–2027

	Tuition	Deposit April 1	June 1 Payment	Sep. 1 Payment	Nov. 1 Payment
Young Nursery	\$1,946.00	\$486.50	\$486.50	\$486.50	\$486.50
2 Day	\$1,689.00	\$422.25	\$422.25	\$422.25	\$422.25
3 Day	\$2,533.00	\$633.25	\$633.25	\$633.25	\$633.25
5 day	\$4,221.00	\$1,055.25	\$1,055.25	\$1,055.25	\$1,055.25

If you have any billing questions, please contact the Operations Manager (see School Directory). Your timely payments are important to the proper functioning of the school. A late fee of \$30.00 is added when a payment is made more than ten days after its due date.

There is a \$25.00 handling charge for each check returned by the bank for insufficient funds or any other reason. There is a \$10 charge for returned ACH transactions through Jovial. There is a \$25 charge for ACH and Credit / Debit card chargeback transactions through Jovial.

Scholarship Program

Our scholarship program provides nursery school education for children who otherwise could not attend. Applications are anonymously reviewed by the Board Chairperson(s), Financial Treasurer, Registrar, and Operations Manager. Selections are based on financial need, scholarship funds available, and the number of eligible applicants. Scholarships are awarded on a first come, first served basis. Interested families should apply as soon as possible after completing their enrollment application.

School Bylaws

Excerpt from the Bylaws (Revised 2025): ARTICLE VI. TUITION AND FEES

1. DEFINITIONS

- a. **Tuition** shall be set annually, and is defined as the sum of money charged by Winton Road Nursery School for a student to attend the school for an academic year. Tuition is paid as follows:
 - i. Four (4) equal payments, due April 1 (deposit), June 1, September 1, and November 1 prior to and during the academic year in which the student is enrolled;
 - ii. One (1) payment of full tuition, due April 1 prior to the academic year in which the student is enrolled;
 - iii. Or a different schedule by special arrangement with the Operations Manager.
- b. The **deposit** is defined as 25% of the annual tuition as defined above, and is non-refundable, except as described in Articles VI.2.c.i-iii (Refunds). This payment is applied to the family's tuition and shall not be returned to the family.
- c. The **application fee** shall be set annually, and is defined as the amount due upon submission of the application form. This fee is non-refundable and non-transferable, and is assessed per student.
- d. The **buyout fee** shall be set annually and is defined as an optional fee charged to a family account at their request, to be relieved of their obligations as a parent volunteer with the exception of the annual fall work day, supporting school fundraisers (max \$75), and providing snacks on a rotating basis. The buyout fee is assessed per family. This fee is refundable only until September 1, and non-refundable thereafter.
- e. The **Registration Contract** represents a binding agreement between WRNS and the related Parents, which obligates the payment of the full tuition to WRNS, by the Parents, for the entire academic year, as defined by and pursuant to the terms of the Registration Contract, and in consideration, WRNS must provide student placement in the defined class to the listed child for the duration of the same academic year, provided there is sufficient enrollment in the class. If class enrollment is not sufficient, WRNS may, in its discretion by Board vote, cancel that class.
- f. **Instructional weeks** are defined as the approximately forty (40) weeks in an academic year for Big Nursery, and thirty-nine (39) weeks for Young Nursery. When calculating a tuition refund, the number of **instructional weeks** is rounded up to the nearest whole week.

- g. **Paid in Full Discount** is defined as a 3% discount on each student's tuition when a family pays the full tuition as outlined in the Registration Contract by **April 1** prior to the academic year of enrollment. This discount can be combined with the **Sibling Discount**.
- h. The **Sibling Discount** is defined as a 2% discount on each student's **tuition** for families with more than one child enrolled simultaneously in the same academic year. This discount can be combined with the **Paid in Full Discount**.
- i. The **Late Fee** is defined as a \$30 charge applied to family accounts that are more than ten (10) days past due.

2. REFUNDS

- a. The **application fee** is non-refundable and non-transferable, and is assessed per student.
- b. The **buyout fee** is fully refundable before September 1, and non-refundable thereafter.
- c. As provided in the **Registration Contract**, parents are obligated to pay the full **tuition** for the entire academic year as defined therein . The only exceptions to this obligation are as follows:
 - i. **Illness or Physical Condition:** At any time during the year, a student that develops a condition or illness that in the written opinion of their physician will keep them from attending school for 4 consecutive weeks OR fully participating in school activities. In this case the family may request a tuition refund less the number of **instructional weeks** that have occurred before the withdrawal date.
 - ii. **Extreme Financial Hardship:** At any time during the year, if a family experiences extreme financial hardship due to the loss of employment or major life event, a family may request a tuition refund less the number of **instructional weeks** that have occurred prior to the withdrawal date. Proof of a change in financial status should be submitted to the Board alongside the refund request.
 - iii. **Relocation:** In the event a family is relocating more than 15 miles from WRNS before February 1 of academic year, and provides 30 days notice of their withdrawal date, a request may be made by the family for a **tuition** refund less the number of **instructional weeks** prior to the withdrawal date. Notice must be provided prior to February 1 in the event the relocation and withdrawal date is thereafter in order for the refund request to receive consideration.
- d. Voluntary Student Withdrawal:
 - i. **Before and on April 1:** If a family elects to withdraw a student after returning their signed **Registration Contract** for the upcoming academic year for any reason not listed in Articles VI.2.c.i-iii (Refunds), the withdrawing family forfeits the **application fee**.

- ii. **After April 1 and before September 1:** If a family elects to withdraw a student for any reason not listed in Articles VI.2.c.i-iii (Refunds), the withdrawing family may request a **tuition** refund, and forfeits the **application fee** and **deposit** provided for in the **Registration Contract** to defray the administrative costs of the registration process.
- iii. **After September 1 and before February 1:** If a family elects to withdraw a student for any reason not listed in Articles VI.2.c.i-iii (Refunds), the withdrawing family may request a **tuition** refund, and forfeits the **application fee** and **deposit**, plus **tuition** incurred for the number of **instructional weeks** the student has attended beyond the first ten (10) weeks of school.
- iv. **After February 1:** If a family elects to withdraw a student for any reason not listed in Articles VI.2.c.i-iii (Refunds), no refunds will be granted.

e. School-Mandated Student Withdrawal

- i. **Prior to July 15:** In the event that WRNS cancels a class or modifies the class days based upon insufficient enrollment or for any other reason, all deposits and tuition payments shall be refunded. Said refunds shall not require Board approval. The application fee is non-refundable.
- ii. **After September 1 and before February 1:** If the student is requested to withdraw by the Board OR there is a mutual agreement between the Board and the student's parents that the student should withdraw, the family may request a deposit and tuition refund less the number of instructional weeks that have occurred, given that the conditions below are met prior to the withdrawal.
 - a. The student shall have completed six (6) consecutive weeks of classes.
 - b. The student's parents have attended at least two (2) parent-teacher conferences. A parent-teacher conference is defined as a pre-arranged meeting, of at least fifteen (15) minutes, with at least one (1) parent of the child, and the appropriate WRNS Teacher and support personnel (as determined by the Operations Manager). Attendance of both parents may be required at the discretion of the teacher.
 - c. The Operations Manager and the student's Teacher shall have observed in class and shall have submitted written statements recommending the withdrawal of the student.

3. PROVISION FOR LATE PAYMENTS

- a. All payments made later than ten (10) days after the due date will be subject to a **late fee** of \$30.00.
- b. Failure to remit the first **tuition** payment within ten (10) calendar days of the initial due date may result in the loss of enrollment, after written notice, and at the

Registrar's discretion.

- c. If the June 1 **tuition** payment has not been made by September 1 (and enrollment has not previously been rescinded), the child will not be able to attend school until payment (including applicable late fees) is made. Failure to pay the installments due in September and November within twenty (20) calendar days of the due date will also preclude the child from attending school until payment (including applicable **late fees**) is made.
- d. In cases of financial hardship, parents should contact the Operations Manager to make special arrangements.

4. PROVISION FOR RETURNED PAYMENTS AND CHARGEBACKS

- a. If an ACH payment is made on Jovial and is returned, the school will charge the family a \$10 fee. If an ACH or Credit Card payment results in a chargeback, the school will charge the family a \$25 fee. These fees are the cost that Jovial charges and represent no markup.
- b. The family may request a refund for these fees in the event of a school accounting error, financial hardship, or other extreme circumstance.

A complete version of the bylaws is available through Jovial. The portion above is also posted on wintonroad.org.

School Policies

Winton Road Nursery School Board of Directors

The operation of the nursery school is conducted by an elected Board which meets once a month. Parents are welcome and encouraged to attend Board meetings. A weekly school newsletter is published on Sundays and distributed by email. The newsletter is an important link of communication between parents, the Board, and the teachers. Each class also has a class parent representative who works with the teachers to get ready for events and other fun programming for our school. Descriptions of board positions and responsibilities are available in the next section, as well as on the school website. A complete board handbook is available upon request.

Staff

The hiring of teachers for the Winton Road Nursery School is the responsibility of the Board of Directors. A majority vote of the Board of Directors, a quorum being present, shall be required to hire a teacher. The teachers, as stated in their contracts, are expected to abide by the Rules and Regulations contained in the Employee Handbook of the Winton Road Nursery School. If a parent feels that a staff member is not fulfilling his/her responsibilities and/or abiding by the Employee Handbook, they should request a meeting with the staff person to discuss these concerns. See the "Who Do I Contact" chart later in this handbook, and the Conflict Resolution policy outlined in the Code of Conduct section.

Snack

Families with non-allergy dietary restrictions or food preferences should plan to pack their own snack each day, but are not exempted from the snack rotation. Families with documented allergies may opt out of snack rotation.

Families provide a nut-free nutritious snack for the school on a rotating basis. A monthly snack calendar will be posted on the bulletin board outside the classrooms, in the monthly newsletter, Jovial, and on the Groupspot app. Please check the snack calendar frequently and make arrangements for a substitute if needed. If you miss an assigned snack day, please bring a snack the next time you come to school. Children drink from paper cups and do not need to bring water bottles.

QUANTITIES

- 2 Day, 3 Day, and 5 Day programs: 35- 40 portions, napkins and 5 oz. cups.
- Young Nursery program: 15 portions, napkins and 5 oz. cups.

ALLERGIES / DIETARY RESTRICTIONS

If your child has a food allergy, it should be noted on their medical forms. If the allergy is to something such as dairy, wheat, or soy (which are common in many foods), you are requested to provide a snack for your child; in this case, participation in the snack rotation is voluntary. PLEASE, carefully read the Health & Wellness section of this handbook for detailed information on how the school handles food allergies. Children with documented allergies must have an allergy plan on file with the school. If your child has a non-allergy dietary restriction and you plan to send a snack for them every day, please communicate this plan to the teacher. Teachers will not offer shared snacks to children who bring a personal snack to avoid cross contamination and to keep the children's confusion to a minimum.

WHAT TO BRING FOR SNACK

- **All items brought to school must be packaged, prepared foods, or whole fruits / vegetables.** This is due to Health Department regulations. Snacks should either be individually pre-packaged portions in large containers.
- Items from bakeries, such as bagels, are permitted (note, most bagel shops will pre-slice bagels if requested).
- Whole fruit, such as apples, bananas, or clementines, are fine. If additional preparation such as slicing is required, the teaching staff will complete preparation while wearing gloves.
- A refrigerator is available for storing snacks during the school day.
- **Teachers request that choices of flavors be limited** (i.e. bring in one flavor of yogurt). This makes administering snacks a smoother process and reduces the disappointment experienced by children who enjoy having the same snack as their friends.
- **The school operates as nut-free (the building is not a nut-free facility) and we ask all parents to avoid bringing snacks containing nuts.**

✓ SNACK IDEAS LIST ✓

- Applesauce
- Cheerios or other plain cereal
- Fruit cups
- Crackers
- Fresh fruit
- Fresh veggies
- Fruit pouches
- Pretzels
- Cheese Sticks

- Yogurt cups
- Goldfish
- Rice Cakes
- Pita Chips
- Veggie Straws
- Fruit Bars (nut free)
- Granola Bars (nut free)
- Mini muffins
- Mini or whole bagels

WHAT NOT TO BRING

If a snack from this list is brought in, the teachers may substitute a snack from their extra supply.

- Anything with nuts (tree nuts, peanuts, coconut)
- Home baked or home prepared food – not permitted due to Health Department regulations
- Beverages – water will be provided with snack
- Cakes and cookies
- Yogurt in tubes
- Sugary snacks or candy

Toilet Training

Children in the 5 day class should be fully potty trained. 2 and 3 day Big School Children are encouraged to be toilet trained by the start of school. If a child is not toilet trained, it is the parents' responsibility to discuss training progress with the teacher prior to the start of school. If a child experiences a period in their development when they require frequent diaper changes, the school will notify the parent to discuss the situation. The time teachers spend changing diapers is time spent away from other children. The toilet training policy does not apply to Young Nursery students.

Summer Camp

The school typically offers a Summer Camp program for currently enrolled Big Nursery children during the two weeks following the end of school. Children must be potty trained to attend. Children bring their own healthy snack each day. Parents of children with allergies who will be attending camp must alert the teachers and follow the same protocol as during the school year. The child's medication(s) and doctor's permission note must be kept at school. The same policies that govern behavior expectations, drop off and pick up, illness, and attendance apply to summer camp. Volunteers are welcome to help summer camp run smoothly.

Safety

Supervision

When families are on campus with children before and after school hours, children must be directly supervised by an adult. This includes areas like the parking lot, grassy areas, and trails behind the church as they are open to the public and not fenced, backing to residential areas.

Two Staff Rule

There must always be two or more adults in each location where children or youth are present. If it is necessary for a volunteer or staff member to meet individually with a child or youth, it should be done so in a public setting, where they are clearly visible by others. Parent volunteers may not attend to children in the bathroom unless it is their own child. One child is permitted in the bathroom stall at a time.

Reporting Child Abuse

New York State Child Protective Services Act requires school personnel to report any suspicion of child abuse and maltreatment, including neglect, mental abuse, bruises, burns, strange cuts, etc. Parents will be contacted and told that a report was made to the Monroe County Department of Social Services. In New York State, all teachers and child care workers are mandated reporters. If you suspect a child is a victim of abuse or neglect, immediately document the incident, any visible injuries or signs of abuse or neglect, and report it to the Co-Directors in writing. The Co-Directors will then immediately call the mandated reporter NYS hotline upon receipt of the written notice. If you believe the child is in immediate danger, after calling the hotline, call the police.

- If the person suspected of committing abuse or neglect is a caregiver, parent, family member or friend, teacher, community member, or WRNS volunteer, report to the Co-Director.
- If the person suspected of committing abuse or neglect is a Co-Director, report to the Operations Manager.
- If the Operations Manager is the person suspected of committing abuse or neglect, report to the Chair.
- If the chair is the person suspected of abuse or neglect, report to the Operations Manager.
- You may at any time skip this process to report directly to the hotline or police. These guidelines are in place to form a chain of command so that more than one person knows about the allegations. Please see [this document](#) from the Office of Child and Family Services for more information on mandated reporting.

Security Measures

Security is taken very seriously at WRNS. Fire drills are practiced regularly and there is constant supervision of our students. All doors into the building and on the playground remain locked after drop off. In the event of a threat or emergency in the building, all children are locked in their classrooms with the staff. First Unitarian Church has emergency and evacuation plans posted throughout the building. Winton Road Nursery School has its own emergency plan that is available for review. The plan is not posted online for security purposes. If you would like to review the plan, please contact the co-directors or operations manager.

Health & Wellness

Illness & Staying Home Procedures

Please call the school at 442-8340 if your child will be absent. Use the following chart to determine when you should keep your child home from school. Please refer to the most recent guidance for information on quarantine duration and testing procedures for COVID-19. In general, your child should remain at home if they have: a fever, vomiting, or diarrhea or if they are acting listless or not themselves and for at least 24 hours after these symptoms have ceased. When in doubt, stay home!

Medicine Policy

As a general rule, the staff of WRNS does not dispense over-the-counter or prescription drugs to children.

Nutrition

WRNS is committed to the overall health and wellness of our students and, as such, strives to avoid the use of “junk food,” candy, and other sugar-laden foods in the classroom. Please see the snack section for suggestions.

Holiday & Birthday Treat Policy

For the safety of our students with food allergies as well as the health of all children, we encourage the celebration of holidays (Halloween, Valentine’s Day, etc.) and birthdays in non-food ways. Make arrangements with your child’s teacher to come in and read a story, lead a song, or just spend time in the classroom on their special day.

Physical Activity

As part of our commitment to our children’s overall health and wellness, we participate in a variety of physical activities, including playground time (twice daily when possible), indoor large muscle activities during inclement weather, and special visitors who focus on overall well-being.

Accident Procedure

At WRNS, we make every effort to provide a safe environment where children can learn and grow. Just as at home, though, curious children who are busy exploring their surroundings may get hurt. If a child gets a cut, bump, or bruise of a relatively minor nature, a teacher will provide comfort and appropriate care. The teacher will tell the caregiver about the injury at the first opportunity. If, however, the teacher feels that a doctor’s attention might be needed on an emergency basis, the teacher will contact the caregiver, inform them of the nature of the injury, and request her/him to come for the child. We hope there will never be a serious injury at WRNS. If necessary, we would call an ambulance and then contact the caregiver. A teacher or other adult would stay with the child, including going in the ambulance and remaining at the hospital until the caregiver arrives. When an injury has occurred that may require treatment, a teacher will make follow-up contact with the caregiver to determine the nature and extent of the injury and to provide support for the family.

Illnesses & Symptoms

Disease	Incubation Time	Stay Home From School	Remarks
Common Cold	24-72 hours	Frequent coughing, sneezing, need an adult to assist with nose wiping / reminders to wipe nose multiple times an hour.	We expect families to practice common sense and consider others when sending children to school. If they're sick - keep them home!
COVID-19	2-14 days	Until all symptoms are gone, fever free for 24 hours without fever reducing medication.	
Vomiting or Diarrhea or Fever	n/a	24 hours since last incident vomit or diarrhea 24 hours fever free without fever reducing medication	
Fifth Disease	4-14 days; can be up to 20 days	No exclusion - by the time symptoms develop, children are no longer contagious.	Contagious. Symptoms include lacy pink rash on trunk & extremities, slapped cheek appearance on face. Infection during pregnancy can have harmful effects on the fetus.
Head Lice	2-14 days	Until after special medicated shampoo is used and clothing, bedding, and personal items have been thoroughly washed, and scalp and hair are completely nit-free for 24 hrs.	Mild, contagious.
Mumps	12-25 days	Until all swelling is gone. Minimum of 1 week after onset of swelling on either side.	Less contagious than the other common infectious diseases.
Measles	7-21 days	Minimum of 1 week from first appearance of rash.	Highly contagious if the child is not protected by vaccine.
Pink Eye Conjunctivitis	24-72 hours	48 hours after treatment is begun / drainage or secretion of eyes is gone.	Highly contagious, needs treatment.
Chicken Pox / Varicella	10-21 days	Minimum of 1 week from first appearance of rash. All scabs should be dry (without pus) before the child is allowed back in school.	Highly contagious. Spread through the air by sneezing, coughing, contact with mucus or saliva, direct contact with rash.
Hand, Foot & Mouth (Coxsackie virus)	3-5 days	Until blister-like skin lesions disappear.	Mild, contagious.
Impetigo (caused by Staph or Strep)	7-10 days	Until all spots of skin sores dry and are scabbed over and treatment has been initiated..	Usually a strep infection of the skin. Highly contagious, needs treatment.
Molluscum Contagiosum	2-7 weeks, and longer	No exclusion, lesions must be covered.	Contagious through direct contact with infected individuals.
Norovirus	10-50 hours	24 hours since last incident vomit or diarrhea	Highly contagious.
Pertussis (Whooping Cough)	7-21 days	May return after completion of antibiotics or 22 days after cough begins.	Contagious.
Ringworm	4-10 days	Exclude until treatment has begun, cover upon return.	Mild, contagious.
Ruebella / German Measles	14-21 days	Until the rash is gone (5 to 7 days).	Mildly contagious.
Strep Throat or Scarlet Fever	2-5 days	24 hours after treatment has begun.	Non-contagious after 24 hours with antibiotic treatment and may attend school if treatment continues.

The descriptions above are not intended to be professional medical advice or a complete list of symptoms for all listed illnesses / conditions. Seek care advice from your child's pediatrician.

Food Allergies

Winton Road Nursery School shares its classroom space with the First Unitarian Church of Rochester's Sunday School program. We cannot guarantee that Winton Road Nursery School is a peanut- or tree nut*-free environment. However, we recognize the potentially serious health problems which can occur when children with food allergies are exposed to certain foods. * Tree nuts include, but are not limited to, walnut, almond, hazelnut, cashew, pistachio, and Brazil nuts. In order to provide as safe an environment as possible for students with food allergies, the following guidelines have been put in place.

PHYSICIAN'S ORDERS

All students with food allergies requiring medication(s) must have a current Emergency Care Plan (ECP) or Permission to Dispense Medication on file with the school on the first day of school. The plan must include:

- Identified allergies
- Written order for antihistamine and/or epinephrine as per medication guidelines
- Instructions for when and how medication(s) should be administered. The doctor's orders should be stored with the student's medication(s)

PARENTAL RESPONSIBILITY

The parent must indicate on the child's Personal History and Medical forms that the child has an allergy. These forms are filled out in the spring and/or prior to the child's first day.

Before the first day of school, the parent should speak with the teacher about the child's previous allergic reactions, current management, knowledge of allergy, and degree of independence. The parent must also provide a completed Emergency Care Plan form (or Permission to Dispense Medication) along with the medication(s) ordered by the physician, labeled according to medication regulations.

The parent must also inform the teacher of any change in the child's health status or attending physician, and monitor the expiration dates of the medication(s).

If the child's allergy is to wheat, milk, or soy, which are common in many snacks, the parent is responsible for bringing a safe snack for the child on each day the child attends school. The parent should then inform the Snack Coordinator whether that family will be a part of the Snack Rotation or not.

If the child's allergy is to peanuts or tree nuts, the child may bring their own snack each day the child attends school, and inform the Snack Coordinator whether the family will not be a part of the Snack Rotation. Due to possible cross contamination in manufacturing processes for many snack foods, children with nut allergies are strongly encouraged to bring their own snack.

The parent should leave a safe snack at school to be given to the child when the group snack is not on the child's approved list, or when children are given extra snacks if they are still hungry. The snack left at school must be clearly labeled with the child's name.

TEACHER RESPONSIBILITY

Prior to the start of the school year, parents fill out a Personal History form and Medical form for their child. Upon review of these forms, the Director will contact families of children with identified allergies to discuss specific guidelines for each child. In addition, the child's teacher will also call the family in August and/or prior to their first day to make sure all of the information being communicated between parents and the school is clearly understood.

No obvious peanut or tree nut snacks will be served to students. In the case that an obvious peanut or tree nut snack arrives, a snack from the classroom's reserves will be served to all children. There is a list of specific snacks parents are asked not to bring. Teachers will keep this list posted on the hallway bulletin board and in the classroom to reference as necessary. If a snack from this list is brought in, the teachers will instead give the class a substitute snack from their extra supply.

Each individual Emergency Care Plan (or Permission to Dispense Medication) will be reviewed by all staff members at the beginning of the school year.

In the case of a severe allergic reaction, the teachers will call an ambulance and then contact the parent. A teacher or other adult would stay with the child, including going in the ambulance and remaining at the hospital until the parent arrived.

Student Behavior Policy

At Winton Road Nursery School, we believe every child is unique and develops at their own pace. Our goal is to provide a safe, nurturing, and inclusive environment where children ages 2–5 can learn, gain independence, and develop social-emotional skills.

As a semi-cooperative school, families are our partners in supporting their children. At the same time, we are responsible for maintaining the safety and well-being of all students and staff. Our staffing structure and daily schedule cannot support ongoing one-on-one supervision or intensive behavioral interventions. Caregivers may be asked to come into the classroom to support their child or to provide a 1:1 aide in order for their child to attend.

Positive Behavior Supports

An essential part of the learning at WRNS is how to get along with peers. Teachers take an active role in guiding these interactions. Teachers at WRNS employ, but are not limited to, the following strategies:

- **Pre-Teaching:** Social stories and dramatic play to introduce and reinforce skills
- **Environment:** The toys and materials are carefully planned and selected for each class.
- **Observe first, act second:** Teachers pay attention to patterns & observations to guide their responses.
- **Redirect:** Guide children toward appropriate alternative actions, & quieter spaces when needed.
- **Model:** Join in play and model appropriate behavior and language.
- **Get Close:** Get on the child's level as space allows.
- **Provide:** Sensory activities, calm spaces, and other opportunities for regulation.
- **Time - In:** Brief removal for a "time-in" to regain self-control with a teacher's support in a calm space, hallway, or other classroom; caregivers may be notified and requested to pick up their child.
- **Reinforce:** Praise and recognize appropriate behavior.
- **Communicate:** Keep caregivers informed of ongoing and new behaviors.

Teachers and Co-Directors Rights & Responsibilities

Teachers have the right to create and manage their classrooms as they see fit, within the bounds of the Employee Handbook, Code of Conduct, and State / Federal laws. Teachers provide clear expectations of student behavior, ensure a safe and supportive environment, prepare and deliver the curriculum, protect confidential information, complete mandatory reporting, and maintain a high standard of professional and ethical conduct.

Types of Behaviors

Most classroom behaviors will fall into the categories of "Safety Concerns" or "Other Behaviors", as outlined on the next pages. Teachers and Co-Directors may exercise their best judgment for behaviors that do not fit neatly into the following categories. Decisions will prioritize safety and the well-being of all students and staff.

Safety Concerns

During the course of their day, students have numerous interactions with each other, with adults, and with their environment. Occasionally, a child may struggle with safe interactions with their peers, adults, or with classroom materials. Below are guidelines for how WRNS will handle safety concerns.

- Safety concerns might look like **hitting, biting, scratching, kicking, pinching, choking, or throwing objects with the intent to harm**. In all cases, the child **may** be sent home for the day. The teacher will use their best judgement to make a determination based on staff availability, severity of the incident, whether this incident was out of character or part of an established pattern of behavior, readiness of the child to return to the class, and readiness of their peers for the child to return.
- Staff who observed the incident will provide a **written and signed report within 24 hours** to the family of the child. **This report must be signed and returned before the child returns to school.**
 - If another child has visible or suspected injuries, the staff will also provide an injury report to the family of the harmed child.
 - If a staff member is injured, an incident report will be completed and kept on file.
 - At the teacher's discretion, a note may be sent home to the class including resources for families and guidance on how to help their children discuss and process the behavior.
- After the safety concern report is given to the family, in order for the child to return to school (whether they were sent home or not), **a caregiver must attend with the child until a meeting can be scheduled**. This meeting will include the child's caregivers, the teacher, and an educational consultant engaged by WRNS at the teacher's discretion, to discuss the incident and what support(s) may be needed at home and at school – see Support Plan section for details. Childcare will be provided upon request for the family when a meeting is scheduled.
- If a second safety concern incident occurs, a subsequent staff meeting will be held, including the teacher, educational consultant, co-director, and board chair or operations manager as appropriate. The purpose of this follow up meeting will be for staff to assess whether additional supports are needed and to determine next steps.
- If a safety concern is considered **life-threatening** for the child themselves (resulting in injuries such as a self-inflicted concussion, a head injury, a severe laceration, or fracture / broken bones), another child or adult at Winton Road Nursery School (a threat to safety that could result in severe injury or death for others includes, but is not limited to: choking/obstructing an airway, head injuries/concussions, broken bones or severe lacerations), the child will not be permitted to return to school (even with a caregiver acting as an aide) until:
 - A signed incident report has been returned to the teacher.
 - A safety concern meeting has been held.
 - A support plan has been established.
 - A 1:1 caregiver or professional aide has been approved by the Teacher and is in place.
 - A fact finding committee has completed their investigation of the incident and made their recommendation to the Board of Directors.

Other Behaviors

In some cases, children may exhibit behaviors that are physical but are not intended to harm, or are otherwise disruptive to the classroom environment or unsafe. It's important to note that behaviors may have multiple root causes that vary widely based on age, temperament, and development. A two year old hitting is different from a five year old hitting. Likewise a two year old biting is different from a five year old biting. Each situation will be handled at the discretion of the teacher(s) and co-director(s)..

- These behaviors may include **repeated interruptions, running away or hiding (eloping), persistent teasing or provoking of classmates, physical acts like hitting, kicking, pushing, biting, throwing items in a non-aggressive but unsafe manner, inappropriate use of school materials, cursing at children or adults or other inappropriate behaviors.**
- **A note will be sent home to inform the caregiver(s), with their signature required, and the note must be returned to school the next class day.** The teacher may request a brief conversation before school or after pick-up to discuss the matter with the caregiver(s). Teachers will document the notes and other details about the behaviors.
- **If more than two notes are sent home regarding concerning behaviors, a meeting will be scheduled with the child's family, the teacher, and the educational consultant** to explore potential strategies and supports that can be implemented both at school and at home. Teachers will present a support plan to enable the child to continue safely in the classroom. Caregivers may be asked to join the classroom to support their child as a part of said plan.
- Caregivers must make themselves available to meet and to carry out the support plan.
- If behaviors persist even with the support plan in place, a subsequent staff meeting will be held, including the teacher, educational consultant, co-director, and board chair or operations manager as appropriate. The purpose of this follow up meeting will be for staff to assess whether additional supports are needed and to determine next steps.

Support Plans

Teachers, in conjunction with the Board of Directors, reserve the right to construct a support plan to best suit the needs of the student, their classmates, and the school community at large. It is important to note that the teacher(s) and co-director(s) have the final say in the contents and implementation of any support plan as best would fit our child-led, play-based program..

Support plans should not be confused or conflated with a BIP (Behavior Intervention Plan) or official IFSP (Individual Family Service Plan) or IEP (Individualized Education Plan). While Winton Road is not required by state or federal law to follow IEP's or IFSP's, we will to the best of our abilities make reasonable accommodations for children with disabilities enrolled in our program in accordance with ADA Title III. We will conduct an individualized assessment of each child as to whether they can participate with reasonable accommodations, where such accommodations do not present a fundamental alteration to our program or place the child, other children, or adults at risk of serious harm or injury.

In Class Supports:

In class supports may include but are not limited to:

- Material or visual aids deemed appropriate by the teacher(s) (such as a choice chart, a visual schedule, a feelings chart, a calm and cozy corner, etc.).
- Caregiver attendance to give their child direct support.
- A 1:1 professional aide employed by the family to provide the child direct support.

External Supports

External supports may include but are not limited to:

- Evaluation through Monroe County Early Intervention or the child's home school district.
- Observation by an education consultant engaged by Winton Road Nursery School.
- Requiring pick up on days where a caregiver is not able to stay with the child.

Program Limitations & Termination of Care

Removal from the program for safety concerns or other behaviors is a last resort, following documented communication, meeting with caregivers, and a support plan. WRNS staff will make every effort to meet the needs of the families that we serve.

If it becomes clear that the needs of a child or family exceed the support that WRNS staff are able to offer, such as requiring 1:1 supervision to successfully and safely participate in the classroom, intensive behavioral interventions, or caregiver unwillingness to cooperate with the support plans put in place by the teacher(s) and co-director(s), the child or family may be required to withdraw by the teacher(s) with the approval of the co-director(s).

WRNS will work closely with the family to discuss alternative programming and provide connections to community resources. Our priority will always be the safety, success, and dignity of the child, as well as the broader classroom and WRNS community.

Screenings and Formal Evaluations

Get Ready to Grow Screenings

Through a grant funded community partnership with Get Ready to Grow at the Children's Institute, annual **screenings are available for all children enrolled at Winton Road Nursery School..** These screenings cover a range of developmental areas, including vision, dental, height, weight, hearing, motor skills, speech, and social-emotional development at **no cost to the school or families.** It's important to note that **these screenings are not designed to be a diagnosis but to help screen for common childhood developmental issues.**

A child can "pass" all the screenings and still be having a hard time at Winton Road Nursery School, another school setting, or at home. It's important to communicate with your child's teacher about their school experience and to be receptive to their feedback on how it's going.

Formal Evaluations

Formal evaluations are not conducted directly by Winton Road Nursery School staff. However, we fully support Monroe County Early Intervention, local school districts, and other qualified professionals who wish to observe children in our classrooms or request teacher-completed questionnaires as part of a formal evaluation process. These observations help create a comprehensive understanding of a child's development in their natural classroom environment.

As part of a behavior plan for children enrolled, **families may be encouraged to pursue a formal evaluation for one or more developmental areas.** It is important to note that **suggesting an evaluation is not a diagnosis**; rather, it is a way to ensure families have access to additional resources and support that may benefit their child. The process for completing an evaluation and actually receiving services can take weeks to months depending on your school district, and earlier interventions are proven to be more effective.

We aim to support both the child and the family. **Connecting families with available services is a critical part of that support, even if it may not yet be clear to caregivers that such services could be helpful.** Our staff's role is not to diagnose or prescribe interventions outside our scope of care, but to provide resources and make connections to the resources that are available in our community.

We believe open, respectful communication between home and school is essential. Please know that if a teacher brings up the idea of an evaluation, it is coming from a place of love and care for your child and their continued learning and growth at WRNS and beyond.

Children With Disabilities

Winton Road Nursery School supports an inclusive classroom environment. We welcome children with disabilities and special needs and will make reasonable accommodations to support their participation in our program, consistent with our staffing, resources, and program structure. A successful experience depends on clear communication and cooperation among families, staff, and service providers.

Enrollment and Information Sharing

- Prior to application, families should tour the school and speak with the Co-Director(s) to discuss their child's strengths, needs, and program fit. Service providers may be included as appropriate.
- After application, families must complete all required forms and provide detailed information about their child's needs, including any IEP, IFSP, or related documentation. If you require a release of information form, please contact the Operations Manager at operationsmanager@wintonroad.org.
- WRNS highly recommends that parents disclose detailed information about their child's needs, including any IEP, IFSP, or related documentation. While WRNS can not legally require disclosure of disability, if families would like the school to provide accommodations they must disclose the disability and provide formal documentation. If the school determines the requested accommodation would require a fundamental alteration to the program, puts children or adults at serious risk for harm, or is an unreasonable burden, they may deny it. If you require a release of information form, please contact the Operations Manager at operationsmanager@wintonroad.org.
- Families must keep the school informed of any services their child receives, current providers, schedules, and any upcoming changes.

Coordination and Services

- WRNS will cooperate, as appropriate, with outside providers (e.g., school district, Early Intervention, or other agencies).
- Families are responsible for identifying providers, helping facilitate communication with school staff, and informing providers of school breaks and student absences in a timely manner.
- Service providers must coordinate scheduling with the Co-Director(s) and classroom teachers. When multiple services are involved, providers and teachers should communicate to coordinate planning. When multiple children will receive the same service, every effort will be made to align their schedules and providers, as appropriate.
- Whenever possible, services should be provided in the classroom and integrated into the daily routine. Pull-out services should be scheduled to minimize disruption and must be agreed upon by the family, provider, and teacher. If a child will receive multiple services, the provider(s) and the teacher(s) should meet in person or by phone to coordinate schedules.
- The WRNS program runs 9am - 12pm, and the option for group therapy should be discussed with your child's CPSE or Early Intervention coordinator if possible.

Program Expectations and Communication

- WRNS is a small program with limited staffing and does not provide one-to-one aides.
- Children must be able to participate safely and meaningfully within the classroom structure with the available support and staffing.
- WRNS requests that reports about services rendered to children in our program be made available to their teacher.
- If additional support is needed, families may be asked to attend with their child or provide an approved one-to-one aide.
- WRNS will make reasonable efforts to support each child; however, accommodations must not fundamentally alter the program or pose a direct threat to the health or safety of children or adults.
- Ongoing communication between families, staff, and providers is expected. The school may request updates or reports and will work collaboratively to review the effectiveness of supports, ensuring that the services rendered are effective, productive, and do not interfere with the purpose and nature of the program and daily activities.

Volunteers & Teams

For more information and job descriptions, please visit wintonroad.org/current-families. If you

<i>Family Job Options</i>						
Type	Role	#	Daytime Avail.	Hour Estimates	Intensity	BN or YN
Board Officer	Chairperson*	1	Yes	10 - 15 per month	5	Any
Board Officer	Vice Chair*	1	Limited	10 - 15 per month	5	Any
Board Officer	Registrar*	1	No	10-15 in Feb, Mar, Aug, Sep	4	Any
Board Officer	Treasurer*	1	No	5 - 10 per month	4	Any
Board Officer	Secretary*	1	No	5 - 7 per month	4	Any
Board Member	Parent Reps* (YN x 2, 2X BN2, 2x BN3, 1x BN5)	7	Limited	4 - 5 per month	3	1 per class
Team	Tours	10+	Yes	3 - 4 per month	3	Any
Team	Room Helpers	10+	Yes	4 - 6 per month	3	Any
Team	Maintenance & Yard Work	4+	Limited	4 - 6 per month	2	Any
Team	Fundraising	2	Limited	Varies	2	Any
Team	Cleaning	4	No	2 - 3 per month	2	Any
Team	Arts & Crafts	4	No	2 - 3 per month	2	Any
Team	Publicity	2	No	Varies	1	Any
Team	Calendar	2	No	1 - 2 per month	1	BN Only
Solo	Website	1	No	1 - 2 per month	1	BN Only
Note: Jobs with a * are Board Members and must attend monthly board meetings. All board meetings are open to the parent membership.						

<i>Family Job Requirements</i>					
Programs Enrolled	# In Class Helper Days	Class Helper Buyout	Job Requirement	Jobs Buyout	Snack Rotation
1 YN Enrolled	YN - Required 7	\$600	Optional	n/a	Yes
2 YN Enrolled	YN - Required 10- 14	\$600	Optional	n/a	Yes
1 YN Enrolled & 1 BN Enrolled	YN - Required 7 BN - Recommended 1	\$300	Yes	\$300	Yes
1 BN Enrolled	BN - Recommended 1	n/a	Yes	\$600	Yes
2 BN Enrolled	BN - Recommended 2	n/a	Yes	\$600	Yes

have questions, please contact the Chairperson or Vice Chairperson of the Board of Directors.

Code of Conduct: Parents & Caregivers

Parents and caregivers at WRNS are expected to model respect, cooperation, and support for staff, board members, children, and other families.

On the Grounds

- Smoking, vaping, and the use of illicit drugs are prohibited on school grounds.
- Children must be supervised at all times on church grounds, including in the wooded area and trails behind the school.
- Pets should stay at home unless they are a service animal.
- You may park in the spots marked 15 minute parking.
- When gathering on the hill after school, be mindful of children with allergies and dietary restrictions.

In the Classroom

- All visitors must sign in and out of school with their child's teacher.
- Volunteers may not be in a room alone with children with the door closed, unless there are two unaffiliated / non-married / non-related volunteers present.
- Volunteers may not use smart phones or similar electronic devices in the classroom except for emergencies.
- Caregivers who are requested to come into the classroom to support their child will do their best to follow the directions and guidance of the classroom teacher.
- Sometimes children share sensitive information that may not be publicly known. We expect all visitors to maintain the privacy of all children and families at WRNS.

Communicating with Teachers & Staff

- Please use the official phone numbers and email addresses published in the handbook to contact your child's teacher, board members, or staff. Staff will reply to emails generally within 2 business days. Teachers are not expected to reply over school break.
- Be mindful of the time commitment required to answer long emails or to have lengthy phone conversations. If you need to discuss something, the best way to do it is in person at a time that works for both the staff member and the family.
- Constructive communication and engagement are essential to a positive classroom community.
- Use the chart below to determine who should be contacted about what types of issues. If your issue is unanswered after 2 business days, ask the next person listed.
- If you believe that an issue has not been adequately resolved by the school, its staff, or the volunteers involved, and that it needs to be addressed by the Board, please refer to the Conflict Resolution section of this packet.
- Uncooperative, aggressive, demeaning, harassing, threatening, or unsafe parent or caregiver behavior could result in termination of enrollment at the discretion of the Board of Directors in conjunction with the Staff of Winton Road Nursery School, to maintain the safety, well-being of the community, its staff, and the reputation of the school in the wider community.

Code of Conduct: Professional Therapy & Support Providers

At Winton Road Nursery School, work together with local professional therapy and service providers so that all students are able to access the educational resources they need.

Prior to Services

- All providers must email or otherwise provide their credentials to the Operations Manager prior to beginning services for any child at Winton Road Nursery School by emailing operationsmanager@wintonroad.org.
- Required credentials may include a driver license, professional license, contact information, their supervisor's contact information, and other relevant materials at the Operation Manager's discretion.

In the Classroom

- All professional therapy and support providers must sign in and out of school with their clients' teachers.
- Providers may not use smart phones or similar electronic devices in the classroom except for the direct support of their client, emergencies, or official business for their employer.
- Providers will inform teachers of the scope and frequency of their therapies or services, and will work with teachers to support the child within the structure of our play-based, child-led setting.
- Providers will meet on an as needed basis (unless otherwise indicated in a child's IEP or IFSP) as appropriate with the child's teacher to discuss any ongoing issues or general concerns.
- Meetings with teachers must be scheduled in advance at a time that is agreed upon by both the teacher and provider.
- Conflicts should be addressed first with the teacher, then with the co-directors.
- Should services be terminated by the family, school district, or by the provider, notice should be given to the teacher and Operations Manager immediately.

Code of Conduct: Board of Directors

Throughout the school year, the Board of Directors will attend meetings, informal gatherings, and will interact with the greater Rochester community. In all interactions in their organizational capacity, directors will be expected to abide by the Code of Conduct. For the purposes of this code of conduct, board members shall refer to officers, parent representatives, co-directors, and when in attendance or discussing board meetings – parent members. A board member handbook that includes our conflict of interest policy is available by contacting the Operations Manager.

Professionalism

- Board members are expected to conduct themselves in a professional manner.
- Board members are expected to attend meetings in accordance with the bylaws.
- Board members should have a general understanding, willingness to learn about the duties of being a board member, and the legal and ethical requirements of non-profits.
- Board members should complete any draft reading or tasks in a timely manner so that meetings are an effective use of all members and staff time.

Conflicts of Interest

- Board members should be above reproach when it comes to declaring conflicts of interest .
- Likewise, board members should refrain from soliciting votes on board action that directly affects their family (refunds, enrollment, etc.)

Sensitive Matters

- Board members should respect the sensitivity of private matters at meetings and matters brought to them in their official capacity.

Meeting Conduct

- Board members should limit side conversations, disruptions, and behavior that is rude or inappropriate and abide by any meeting rules adopted by the board.
- Board members should not interrupt each other during debate and should wait for each person to have a chance to speak once before any person speaks for a second time.
- Board members who cannot comport themselves in a professional manner may be subject to disciplinary action by the Board such as removal from the meeting, up to and including removal from office or appointment.

Conflict Resolution

Fact Finding Committee

A Fact Finding Committee will be established any time an issue is brought to the Board (e.g. grievance, Code of Conduct violation, etc), and must occur prior to any Emergency Board Meeting, and completed in a timely manner (5 business days). An issue or grievance may be brought by any member of the WRNS community when prior methods of communication have failed.

Requesting a Fact Finding Committee

- To request a fact finding committee, complete the form located [here](#).
- Forms must be filed in writing (printed / digital) with the Board Chairperson or Operations Manager.
- All verbal requests will be redirected to the form.
- Forms must be completed with the specific violations called out.

Responsibilities of the Committee

- The committee will review the form and seek to interview all related parties.
 - Interviews will be conducted separately, not to exceed 30 minutes each, subject to recording.
 - Follow up questions to related parties will be responded to in writing within 24 hours.
 - Related parties may submit a written statement to be presented alongside the committee findings.
- The committee will compile details and provide a summary.
- The committee will make a recommendation to the Board of Directors no more than 5 business days after the initial form is received.

Responsibilities of the Related Parties

- Related Parties will agree not to discuss the details of issue/grievance with the WRNS community at large, including the Fact Finding Committee outside the Grievance process as confidentiality for all parties must be respected.
- Additionally, "Jury Tampering" will not be permitted, and any knowledge of such will be disclosed to the Fact Finding Committee and Officers.
- Threats of legal action (implied and direct) will result in the immediate cessation of communication between the complainant and the Board of Directors and its fact finding committee. Any further communication will be conducted through the school's legal representatives.

Responsibilities of the Board of Directors

- The Chair will set the agenda for the Emergency Meeting based on the submitted Grievance and Findings Forms, and will outline the Rules and Decorum for attendees in advance. Anyone who does not hold to these Rules will be asked to leave the meeting.
- Any discussion will occur within an Executive Session, and related parties are not permitted to attend.
- Related Parties will forfeit their voting rights and will not be able to bring or second motions while the issue is under review, as applicable, due to conflict of interest.
- If the grievance is against a teacher or staff member, this matter is elevated to the Board Officers (no parent reps as they may need to be interviewed by the fact finding committee) and handled as an HR issue.
- Grievances against teachers and staff are not presented in an open board meeting or forum where all parents attend.

Staff Removal

A Staff Member may be removed by a majority vote of the Board of Directors, with a quorum being met, after a minimum of thirty (30) days written notice from the Board to the Staff Member, stating the cause of such intended action.